
What is manual work actually costing you?

A 4-step worksheet to put a number on it before
you automate anything.

swipe →

“It saves time” never gets a budget approved.

“Automation ~~saves time~~”

Finance doesn't fund feelings.

It funds **a number**, and a date it pays back.

Here's how to get both, for one task, in 10 minutes.

STEP 1

Pick one repeated task.

Invoices. Enquiry replies. Weekly reports. Data entry.
How many times a week does it happen?

Frequency / week = _____

STEP 2

Time it.

Time a few real runs. Don't guess.

```
minutes per task
× frequency per week
÷ 60
= hours per week
```

STEP 3

Cost it.

Use the **fully loaded** hourly cost: salary plus overheads, not just pay.

hours per week
× loaded hourly cost
= **weekly cost**

STEP 4

Add the hidden cost.

Time is only half the bill. Estimate these conservatively:

ERRORS

Wrong data, wrong orders

REWORK

Fixing what went wrong

SLOW REPLIES

Customers who stop waiting

MISSED LEADS

Enquiries nobody followed up

WORKED EXAMPLE

Replying to enquiries by hand

20 enquiries/day × 5 days	100 / week
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100 × 6 min ÷ 60	10 hrs / week
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10 hrs × 5,000 per hr	50,000 / week
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That's **50,000 a week**, before a single lost sale.

THE DECISION

Work out the payback.

```
build cost  
÷ weekly cost saved  
= weeks to pay back
```

My rule of thumb: if an automation pays for itself in **under ~12 weeks**, it's usually an easy yes.



Want me to run this on one of
your workflows?

DM me "WORKFLOW"

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